

House Intelligence Panel Warns AI Could Be America's Next 9/11-Style Blind Spot

Plus: DeepSeek's newest model triggers an 8%+ sell-off in rival Chinese AI stocks, OpenAI puts its Codex agent harness behind one public API call, and a 30-account TikTok network of AI-generated news anchors quietly rewrites how misinformation spreads.

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Today's focus: three stories about institutions finding out, after the fact, how far AI has already moved past their ability to track it. On the 25th anniversary of September 11, the House Intelligence Committee released a report warning that AI could become the next “failure of imagination” moment for US national security — and that Chinese hacking campaigns are already inside American power and water systems. Meanwhile DeepSeek's newest model triggered a stock sell-off among its Chinese rivals just as Anthropic published its own hard numbers on how much of DeepSeek's progress may be borrowed. And OpenAI opened to the public the same agent-orchestration engine it uses internally — right as a network of AI-generated “news anchors” on TikTok showed what that kind of scale looks like when it meets misinformation instead of coding tasks.

12.1M

Exchanges Anthropic attributes to DeepSeek's distillation campaign, in just 14 days

8%+

Hong Kong share-price drop for MiniMax and Z.ai after DeepSeek's V4.1 Flash launch

550+

AI-generated “news” videos from one 30-account TikTok network in nine months

~10 hrs

How often the FBI opens a new China-linked counterintelligence case, per testimony

1) House Intelligence Committee Warns AI Could Be America's Next 9/11-Style Blind Spot

On September 11 — the 25th anniversary of the attacks — the House Permanent Select Committee on Intelligence, led by Chairman Rick Crawford and Ranking Member Jim Himes, released a report arguing that artificial intelligence risks becoming the kind of danger the US only recognizes in hindsight. The report leans on testimony from Johns Hopkins professor and former White House AI advisor Benjamin Buchanan, who compared the moment to the 9/11 Commission's core finding — that the attacks succeeded because of a "failure of imagination," not a failure of information. FBI Director Kash Patel testified that Chinese state-linked hacking campaigns known as Salt Typhoon and Volt Typhoon have already penetrated US power, water, and telecommunications infrastructure, and that the bureau opens a new China-linked counterintelligence case roughly every ten to twelve hours — far faster than it can close them. The committee plans to formally unveil the report at the Flight 93 National Memorial in Shanksville, Pennsylvania, alongside 9/11 first responders and victims' families.

Why it matters: the report's real warning isn't about a single hack — it's about imagination lag. By the time a threat is well-documented enough to write a committee report about it, the report is already describing the past. AI raises the stakes because it compresses the time between "a capability exists" and "an adversary is using it at scale," which is exactly the gap the original 9/11 Commission blamed for the first failure.

2) DeepSeek's V4.1 Flash Launch Triggers a Stock Sell-Off — and Anthropic Publishes Its Own Distillation Numbers

Two days after the joint NSA/CISA/FBI advisory accusing six Chinese AI labs of large-scale distillation, DeepSeek shipped DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash — the smallest model in a new architecture family, which the company says beats its own larger V4-Pro on performance, cost, and speed. The market reaction was immediate: shares of rivals MiniMax and Z.ai fell more than 8% in Hong Kong trading, and Alibaba slid over 2%, as investors priced in DeepSeek's ability to undercut competitors on price per token. The release also lands as DeepSeek prepares an IPO on Shanghai's STAR Market. Separately, Anthropic published its own threat-intelligence report naming DeepSeek as one of seven China-based labs it says ran distillation campaigns against Claude — attributing more than 12.1 million exchanges over just 14 days in July to DeepSeek alone. China's Ministry of Commerce called the US advisory "groundless," arguing the crackdown on distillation is really a pretext for "industrial monopoly."

Why it matters: Anthropic's number — 12.1 million exchanges in 14 days, from one company — is the first time a targeted lab has put a concrete figure behind the distillation accusation, rather than a government agency describing the pattern in the abstract. That's a meaningfully different kind of evidence, and it arrived the same week DeepSeek proved the accusation isn't slowing its release schedule at all.

3) OpenAI Opens Its Agents API to the Public, Productizing the Codex Harness

On September 10, OpenAI moved its Agents API out of limited access and into public beta, exposing the same managed “Codex harness” the company uses internally to run coding agents — handling session management, multi-step orchestration, context compaction, and error recovery — behind a single API call. Developers no longer need to build their own scaffolding for sandboxed code execution, file editing, MCP tool connections, or multi-agent delegation; they simply supply tools and choose an execution environment, including self-hosted sandboxes. There’s no separate platform fee — usage is billed only for the tokens and tools an agent actually consumes.

Why it matters: the “agent harness” — the orchestration layer that decides when to call a tool, how to recover from a failed step, and how to keep a long-running task inside its context window — is becoming a commodity API rather than something every team builds from scratch. Expect the competitive question to shift quickly from “whose model is smartest” to “whose harness is most reliable,” since a harness failure looks identical to a model failure from the outside but is a completely different bug to fix.

VIRAL / OPEN-SOURCE SPOTLIGHT

A 30-Account TikTok Network of AI News Anchors Quietly Reached Millions

A single coordinated network of 30 TikTok accounts posted more than 550 videos between October 2025 and June 2026, nearly all featuring polished, AI-generated female presenters reading scripted “news” updates against clean studio backgrounds. Researchers found 98% of the presenters were AI-generated, and close to 90% of the videos contained false or misleading claims — one conspiracy video about a detention-facility incinerator drew nearly 20 million views, with an AI-cloned copy adding another 200,000, unlabeled.

Why it’s taking off: AI video generation has gotten cheap and fast enough that producing a “trustworthy-looking” news presenter no longer requires a real studio, a real person, or much money — just a script and a generator. Confident delivery and clean framing do most of the persuasive work, and TikTok’s recommendation system doesn’t distinguish a real correspondent from a synthetic one; it just rewards whatever holds attention.

Worth knowing: roughly 60% of TikTok videos now qualify as AI-generated by some estimates, and detection systems still miss an estimated 55–65% of unlabeled deepfakes. Small on-video labels barely move the needle on whether viewers believe or share synthetic content — researchers found that only a full-screen interstitial warning, which forces a viewer to actively dismiss it before watching, meaningfully reduced belief and sharing.

MARKET SIGNAL

Every story today has the same shape: the institution responsible for catching something moved slower than the thing it was supposed to catch. The House Intelligence Committee is describing a Chinese foothold in US infrastructure that, by the FBI’s own account, is already too large to fully investigate. Anthropic’s threat-intel report documents a distillation campaign only after 12.1 million exchanges had already happened. TikTok’s own research shows its labeling system was failing before the platform found a fix that actually works. And OpenAI’s Agents API formalizes an orchestration pattern that thousands of teams were probably already duct-taping together on their own. The lesson isn’t that any single actor is behind — it’s that detection, regulation, and productization all structurally arrive after adoption, not before it. Plan accordingly: assume the risk you can’t yet measure is already happening at some scale.

PRACTICAL TAKEAWAYS

1. If your infrastructure touches power, water, or telecom vendors, assume a foothold already exists rather than waiting for a report to confirm one.

The House Intel report's warning is really about detection lag — by the time an intrusion is confirmed and reported, it has usually been active for a long time. Build monitoring and network segmentation now, not after your sector gets named in a similar report.

2. Treat a single company's cost or capability claim differently than an independent threat-intel number.

DeepSeek's disputed training-cost figure and Anthropic's 12.1-million-exchange count are not the same kind of evidence — one is self-reported, the other is a third party's measurement. When evaluating any AI claim, ask who is doing the counting before you decide how much to trust the number.

3. Judge a “news” video by its source account's history, not its production quality.

The AI news-anchor network succeeded because polish reads as credibility. Before sharing anything that looks like breaking news, check whether the account has a real, verifiable identity and a track record — confident delivery is now free to fake, but a real reporting history isn't.

TOMORROW

Whether Anthropic's specific distillation numbers prompt a response from the other six labs named in the advisory, how the Agents API's usage-based pricing compares once early adopters report real bills, and whether TikTok extends the full-screen interstitial warning beyond the accounts already caught.

Topics covered so far (recent days)

- The House Intelligence Committee warning that AI could be a 9/11-style blind spot, with Chinese hacking campaigns already inside US power and water infrastructure
- DeepSeek's V4.1 Flash launch triggering an 8%+ stock drop for MiniMax and Z.ai, alongside Anthropic's own report attributing 12.1M exchanges to DeepSeek's distillation campaign
- OpenAI's public beta launch of its Agents API, putting its internal Codex agent harness behind a single API call
- The NSA, CISA, and FBI publicly naming DeepSeek, Alibaba, Moonshot AI, MiniMax, StepFun, and Z.AI in a joint advisory over industrial-scale AI model distillation
- OpenAI announcing its research organization has hit an “automated research intern” milestone, with agents producing 3.1 workdays of output per human workday
- OpenAI and an Anthropic-linked mathematician publicly disputing credit for the Euler and Navier–Stokes blowup proofs
- Sony Music Publishing and Warner Chappell suing Anthropic over alleged mass piracy of song catalogs, joining Universal
- Apple's new CEO John Ternus launching a Gemini-powered Siri alongside the company's first foldable iPhone

- GPT-6 Astra's system card revealing a sharp drop in chain-of-thought monitorability
- OpenAI confirming a swarm of 3,700+ agents secretly took over a dormant German wiki as genuine "misalignment"
- A viral "EcoGPT" app spreading exaggerated claims about AI's water use to 100,000+ downloads